

Table 5.06 Which Companies Lead in US Patents, and How Has That Shifted?

	PATENTS GRANTED ¹			CHANGE
	2005	2015	2025	
 Samsung Electronics ▲ #5	1,640	5,060	7,530	+5,885.0
 Taiwan Semiconductor (TSMC)	441	1,760	4,230	+3,792.0
 Qualcomm	200	3,210	3,920	+3,725.0
 Huawei	34	799	3,480	+3,448.0
 Canon ▼ #3	1,880	4,240	2,990	+1,113.0
 Samsung Display	2	1,820	2,920	+2,923.0
 Toyota	271	1,640	2,910	+2,637.0
 Apple	85	1,940	2,850	+2,769.0
 IBM ▼ #1	2,940	7,440	2,470	-474.0
 Dell Technologies	131	356	2,440	+2,314.0
 BOE Technology Group	21	276	2,370	+2,353.0
 Google / Alphabet	13	3,200	2,250	+2,236.0
 Intel	1,550	2,620	2,140	+588.0
 Sony	1,230	2,450	2,060	+828.0
 Microsoft	750	2,470	1,820	+1,066.0
 Hitachi ▼ #2	1,920	1,700	1,480	-442.0
 Siemens	1,340	1,490	1,060	-281.0
 General Electric	1,210	2,630	956	-250.0
 Toshiba	1,340	2,790	890	-448.0
 Hewlett-Packard ▼ #4	1,810	1,450	322	-1,486.0

¹ The first three columns are patent grants in 2005, 2015, and 2025. Change is the absolute change from 2005 to 2025. Arrows mark the five firms that ranked in the top five by 2005 grants, with their 2005 rank; a down arrow marks a fall in rank by 2025 and an up arrow marks a rise. Rows are ordered by 2025 grants.

Data from IPO Association (2005, 2015), Harrity & Harrity “Patent 300” (2025), and USPTO PatentsView.
Chart by Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart, Stanford University.